“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 14

The Divine Madness of Śrī Caitanya in Separation from Kṛṣṇa

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Now I shall tell a small part of all that Gaurāṅga did with His mind, body and intelligence in the bewilderment born of separation from Kṛṣṇa.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya, the Supreme Lord Himself! Glory, glory to Gauracandra, the life of His devotees!

3 Glory, glory to Nityānanda, the life of Caitanya! Glory to Advaitācārya, most dear to Gaura!

4 Glory to Svarūpa, to Śrīvāsa and to all the Lord’s devotees! Grant me the strength to describe Śrī Caitanya.

5 The Lord’s mood of madness in separation is profound: no one can understand it, even if he is wise.

6 What we cannot understand — who can describe it? Only he understands and describes it to whom Caitanya gives the power.

7 These pastimes are revealed in the diaries (*kaḍacā*) of these two, Svarūpa Gosāñi and Raghunātha dāsa.

8 At that time these two lived at Mahāprabhu's side, while all the other diarists lived in distant places.

9 Experiencing His pastimes moment by moment, these two recorded them in their diaries, sometimes briefly and sometimes at length.

10 Svarūpa is the author of the *sūtras*, and Raghunātha the author of their explanation (*vṛtti*). I describe them more fully, in the manner of a *pāǰi-ṭīkā* (an introductory commentary).

11 Place your faith in this and hear the description of these emotions. You will come to understand them and gain the treasure of love.

12 The state that came upon the *gopīs* when Kṛṣṇa went to Mathurā arose in the Lord in His separation from Kṛṣṇa.

13 Just as Rādhā lamented on seeing Uddhava, so, little by little, the Lord broke into the lament of madness.

14 In the mood of Rādhikā the Lord always had her self-conception (*abhimāna*); in that mood He thought of Himself as Rādhā.

15 In divine madness (*divyonmāda*) this is how it is — what is surprising in that? In *adhirūḍha-bhāva* the incoherent talk of divine madness arises.

16 "When the *bhāva* called *mohana* reaches a certain indescribable state, there appears a wondrous display resembling bewilderment; it is called divine madness (*divyonmāda*). It is held to have many varieties, such as *udghūrṇā* and *citra-jalpa*." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi 14.190)

17 One day Mahāprabhu had lain down to rest, and He dreamed that Kṛṣṇa was performing the *rāsa-līlā*.

18 His beautiful body was bent in three places, the flute was at His lips; He wore yellow cloth and a garland of forest flowers — He was the enchanter of Madana, the god of love.

19 The *gopīs* danced in a circle, and in the middle the son of the king of Vraja danced with Rādhā.

20 Seeing this, the Lord became absorbed in that *rasa* and thought, “I have found Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana!”

21 Seeing that the Lord was late in rising, Govinda woke Him. On waking, the Lord understood that it had been a dream, and He became sorrowful.

22 Out of bodily habit He completed His daily duties, and at the proper time He went to see Jagannātha.

23 He would look at Jagannātha from behind the Garuḍa pillar, and in front of the Lord hundreds of thousands of people were looking too.

24 An Oriyā woman who could not see through the crowd climbed onto the Garuḍa pillar and looked, placing her foot on the Lord’s shoulder.

25 Seeing this, Govinda hastily tried to put her off, but the Lord forbade Govinda to bring her down.

26 “Foolish fellow (*ādivasyā*)! Do not remove this woman. Let her look at Jagannātha as much as she wishes.”

27 That woman hurriedly came down to the ground, and, seeing Mahāprabhu, she bowed at His feet.

28 Seeing her eagerness, the Lord began to speak: “Jagannātha has not given Me such eagerness!

29 Her body, mind and life are absorbed in Jagannātha; she does not even know that she has put her foot on My shoulder.

30 Oh, how fortunate she is! I bow to her feet. By her grace may such eagerness arise in Me too.

31 Before, when I looked at Jagannātha, I saw in Jagannātha the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

32 Absorbed in what I saw in the dream, My mind stayed in that state, and wherever I looked I saw everywhere the One with the flute at His lips."[1]

33 Now, when on seeing the woman the Lord came to external consciousness, He saw the forms of Jagannātha, Subhadrā and Balarāma.

34 His mind became like that of one who sees Kṛṣṇa at Kurukṣetra: "Where have I come — to Kurukṣetra! And where is Vṛndāvana?"

35 Like one who has lost a jewel he had found, He became agitated, and the Lord came back, dejected, to His residence.

36 Sitting on the ground, He scratched the ground with His nails; a Ganges of tears flowed from His eyes, and He saw nothing at all.

37 "I found the Lord of Vṛndāvana, and I have lost Him again! Who has taken My Kṛṣṇa? Where have I come?"

38 Absorbed in the dream, the Lord's mind overflowed with love; when external consciousness returned, it was as if He had lost a treasure.

39 Like a madman the Lord sang and danced; He bathed and ate only by the habit of the body.

40 When night came, He would sit with Svarūpa and Rāmānanda and open to them the feelings of His heart.

41 “My mind found the wealth of Acyuta and lost it again. In its grief it abandoned its house, the body, took up the ways of a *kāpālika* yogī, and went off to Vṛndāvana with its band of disciples, the senses.”

42 Having lost the jewel He had found and remembering its qualities, Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with anguish. Clasping Rāya and Svarūpa by the neck, He cried, “Alas! Hari! Hari!” His composure gone, He became restless.

43 “Hear, My friends, of Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness! Craving it, My mind has given up the duties of society and of the Vedas, become a yogī and turned beggar.

44 The circle of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes is its pure conch-shell earrings, fashioned by the craftsman Śuka. Wearing those earrings, holding the gourd-bowl of thirst, with the bag of hope over its shoulder,

45 wrapped in the patched quilt of anxiety, its body soiled with dust and ash, it answers everything with the raving cry, “Alas, Kṛṣṇa!” The twelve bangles of agitation are on its arm, the bag of longing is on its head, and for lack of alms its body has grown thin.

46 The yogīs Vyāsa, Śuka and others have described in the Bhāgavata and the other scriptures all the pastimes in Vraja of Kṛṣṇa, the stainless Self; those songs (*tarjā*) it recites constantly.

47 Making the ten senses its disciples and taking the name “Mahā-bāul”, it set off with its disciples. Leaving everything — its own home, My body, and the great wealth of sense enjoyment — it went to Vṛndāvana.

48 The subjects of Vṛndāvana — all beings, stationary and moving, the trees and creepers — live as householders. It begs in their homes and eats fruits, roots and leaves; this is how it lives with its disciples.

49 The *gopīs* relish the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's qualities, form, taste, fragrance, sound and touch. The disciples, the five senses, bring the remnants of their meal, and on those alms they sustain their lives.

50 In the corner of an empty bower-pavilion it stays with its disciples, practising yoga in meditation on Kṛṣṇa. Longing to see Kṛṣṇa, the stainless Self, face to face, it stays awake all night in meditation.

51 Separated from Kṛṣṇa, My mind became a yogī in its sorrow, and in that separation the ten states arose. Distraught in those states, the mind fled away, and My body, its dwelling, stands empty."

52 In separation from Kṛṣṇa ten states arise in the *gopīs*; those same ten states arose in the Lord.

53 "Here the ten states are anxious thought, sleeplessness, agitation, emaciation, uncleanliness of body, incoherent talk, disease, madness, fainting and death." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi 15.167)

54 Night and day the Lord was distraught by these ten states: now one state would arise, now another, and His mind found no rest.

55 Having said this, Mahāprabhu fell silent, and Rāmānanda Rāya began to recite verses.

56 Svarūpa Gosāñi sang of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, and together the two brought the Lord somewhat back to external awareness.

57 In this way they passed half the night, and then they had the Lord lie down in the inner room.

58 Rāmānanda Rāya then went home, and Svarūpa and Govinda both lay down at the door.

59 Mahāprabhu stayed awake all night, loudly chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa.

60 Hearing no sound, Svarūpa opened the door: the three doors were still shut, yet the Lord was not in the room.

61 Not seeing the Lord, everyone grew anxious, and in great distress they all went about looking for Him.

62 On the north side of the Siṁha-dvāra (the Lion Gate) there is a certain spot, and there Caitanya Gosāñi lay fallen.

63 Seeing Him, Svarūpa Gosāñi and the others were overjoyed; but when they saw the Lord's condition, they grew anxious again.

64 The Lord lay there, five or six cubits long. His body was unconscious, and no breath moved in His nostrils.

65–66 Each of His arms and legs had become three cubits long. The joints of His bones had come apart: only the skin remained, and the warmth of life. His hands, feet, neck and waist, His bones and all His joints had each come apart by a span.

67 Over the joints there was only skin, and they lay drawn out. Seeing the Lord in this state, everyone was stricken with grief.

68 Saliva and foam were at the Lord's mouth, and His eyes were turned upward. Seeing this, all the devotees felt as if life were leaving their bodies.

69 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi, together with the devotees, loudly chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa into the Lord's ear.

70 After a long while the name of Kṛṣṇa entered His heart. Crying "Haribol!", the Lord rose up with a roar.

71 As He regained consciousness, the joints of His bones came together, and His body became just as it had been before.

72 Raghunātha dāsa has described this pastime of Mahāprabhu in his *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

73 "Once, in the house of Miśra, in intense separation from the son of the lord of Vraja, the beauty and the joints of His limbs gave way, and His arms and legs grew unnaturally long. Rolling on the ground, in utter distress, He wept piteously in a voice choked with feeling. That Śrī Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, makes me mad with joy." (*Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*, 4)

74 Finding Himself at the Siṁha-dvāra, the Lord was astonished, and He asked Svarūpa, "What are you doing? Why?"[2]

75 Svarūpa said, "Get up, Prabhu, and come to Your own room. There I shall tell You everything."

76 Saying this, he held the Lord and took Him to His room, and there began to tell Him all about the state He had been in.

77 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu was greatly astonished. The Lord said, "I remember nothing of it!

78 I only see that My Kṛṣṇa is present: He appears like a flash of lightning and vanishes.”

79 Just then the conch (*pāni-śaṅkha*) of Jagannātha sounded, and Mahāprabhu bathed and went for *darśana*.[3]

80 Thus I have described the Lord’s wonderful transformations; whoever hears of them is struck with wonder.

81 People have never seen such things, nor do we hear of them in the scriptures; yet the crest-jewel of *sannyāsīs* manifests such ecstasy.

82 Ordinary people cannot be convinced of emotions that lie beyond the scriptures and beyond this world.

83 Raghunātha dāsa always stayed with the Lord. I write what I heard from his own lips, with full faith in it.

84 One day, as Mahāprabhu was going to the sea, He suddenly saw the sand hill called Caṭaka-parvata.

85 Taking it for Govardhana Hill, He was overwhelmed with ecstasy, and the Lord ran toward the hill.

86 “Ah, friends, this hill is the best of Hari’s servants! Thrilled by the touch of the feet of Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, it honours Them, together with Their cows and companions, with water to drink, fine grass, caves, and bulbs and roots.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.18)

87 Reciting this verse, the Lord ran with the speed of the wind. Govinda ran after Him but could not catch up.

88 A cry went up, and there was a great uproar. Everyone, wherever he was, got up and ran.

89 Svarūpa, Jagadānanda, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Rāmāi, Nandāi and Śaṅkara Paṇḍita all ran.

90 Purī Gosāñi and Bhāratī Gosāñi came to the seashore, and the lame Bhagavān Ācārya followed very slowly.

91 At first the Lord went like the wind; but on the way the ecstasy of stupor (*stambha*) came over Him, and He had no strength to move.

92 At every pore the flesh swelled up like a boil, and on it the hairs stood on end, like the filaments of a *kadamba* flower.

93 From every pore sweat poured out with streams of blood. His throat gurgled, and He could not utter a single syllable.

94 His two eyes filled, and tears flowed endlessly, as if the streams of the Gaṅgā and the Yamunā had met the sea.

95 His pallor was like that of a conch, and His body turned white. Then a trembling arose in Him, like waves on the sea.

96 Trembling and trembling, the Lord fell to the ground. Then Govinda came up to Him.

97 With water from the waterpot (*karaṅga*) he sprinkled the Lord's whole body, and with the outer cloth he fanned Him.

98 Svarūpa and the others came and joined them there; seeing the Lord's condition, they began to weep.

99 They saw in the Lord's body the eight *sāttvika* transformations, and seeing these wonderful *sāttvika* signs, they were amazed.

100 They sang loud *saṅkīrtana* right at the Lord's ear and bathed His body with very cool water.

101 When they had sung *kīrtana* in this way many times, the Lord suddenly rose, crying "Haribol!"

102 Joyfully all the Vaiṣṇavas cried, "Hari! Hari!", and an auspicious sound arose, filling the four directions.

103 Having risen, Mahāprabhu looked here and there in astonishment, but what He wanted to see He could not see.

104 Seeing the Vaiṣṇavas, the Lord came half into external consciousness and began to say something to Svarūpa Gosāñi:

105 "Who has brought Me here from Govardhana? I had found Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, but I could not go on seeing them.

106 Today I went from here to Govardhana to see whether Kṛṣṇa was grazing the cows.

107 Kṛṣṇa climbed Govardhana and played His flute, and all around Govardhana the cows were grazing.

108 Hearing the sound of the flute, Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī came, beautifully dressed and adorned, with all Her *sakhīs*.

109 Kṛṣṇa took Rādhā with Him and entered a cave, and some of the *sakhīs* wanted to gather flowers.[4]

110 Just then all of you raised an uproar, seized Me, and brought Me here from there.

111 Why did you bring Me here, only to give Me pain for nothing? I had found Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, but I could not see them."

112 Saying this, Mahāprabhu wept, and seeing His condition, the Vaiṣṇavas wept too.

113 Just then the two, Purī and Bhāratī, arrived. Seeing them both, Mahāprabhu was filled with reverence.

114 When He came fully into external consciousness, the Lord offered His respects to them both, and the two embraced Mahāprabhu with love.

115 The Lord said, "Why have you two come so far?" Purī Gosāñi said, "To see Your dancing."

116 At Purī's words the Lord was embarrassed, and He went with all the Vaiṣṇavas to the bathing place at the sea.

117 After bathing, Mahāprabhu returned home and, together with everyone, partook of *mahā-prasāda*.

118 Thus I have described the Lord's mood of divine madness (*divyonmāda*), whose power even Brahmā cannot describe.

119 Raghunātha dāsa has described the pastime of the Lord's running to Caṭaka-giri in his *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

120 "Near Nīlādri He saw Caṭaka-giri, a king among hills, and cried, 'Oh, from here I am going to Vraja to see Govardhana, the king of hills!' Saying this, He ran like a madman, and His own companions followed Him. That

Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, makes me mad with joy.” (*Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*, 8)

121 Who can understand the extraordinary pastimes the Lord performed in those days — that play of Mahāprabhu?[5]

122 Telling it briefly, I have only pointed the way. Whoever hears this attains the feet of Kṛṣṇa.

123 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Verses 28–32 are the Lord’s words, as in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (the quotation closes after verse 32). Some editions read verse 31 as *pūrve āsi’ yabe … jagannāthe dekhe*, which makes verses 31–32 the narrator’s account. ↩
2. *Kyā kara, kibā* is Hindustani (*keyā karo, keṁo*): “What are you doing? Why?” (*Anubhāṣya*). In half-external consciousness, the Lord asks why people have gathered around Him. ↩
3. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *pāni-śaṅkha*. The *Anubhāṣya* explains *pāṇi-śaṅkha* as a conch held in the hand and blown (or the clapping of hands when the temple doors are opened), and, by another reading, *pānī-śaṅkha*, a conch [holding water] for *ācamana*. ↩
4. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *sakhī-gaṇa cāhe keha phula uṭhāite*, “some of the *sakhīs* wanted to gather flowers”; other editions read *sakhī-gaṇa kahe more phula uṭhāite*, “the *sakhīs* told Me to gather flowers”. ↩
5. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *ke bujhite pāre*, “who can understand”; other editions read *ke varṇite pāre*, “who can describe”. ↩